AFRICAST

TIDY TIME SERIES & FORECASTING IN R

Transformations, decompositions and features



SECTION 1 OF 5

Transforming time series

1 **Transforming time series** 2 Adjusting time series 3 Time series decompositions 4 STL Features 5 Clustering features



Variance stabilisation

If the data show different variation at different levels of the series, then a transformation can be useful.

Denote original observations as $y_1, \ldots, y_n$ and transformed observations as $w_1, \ldots, w_n$.

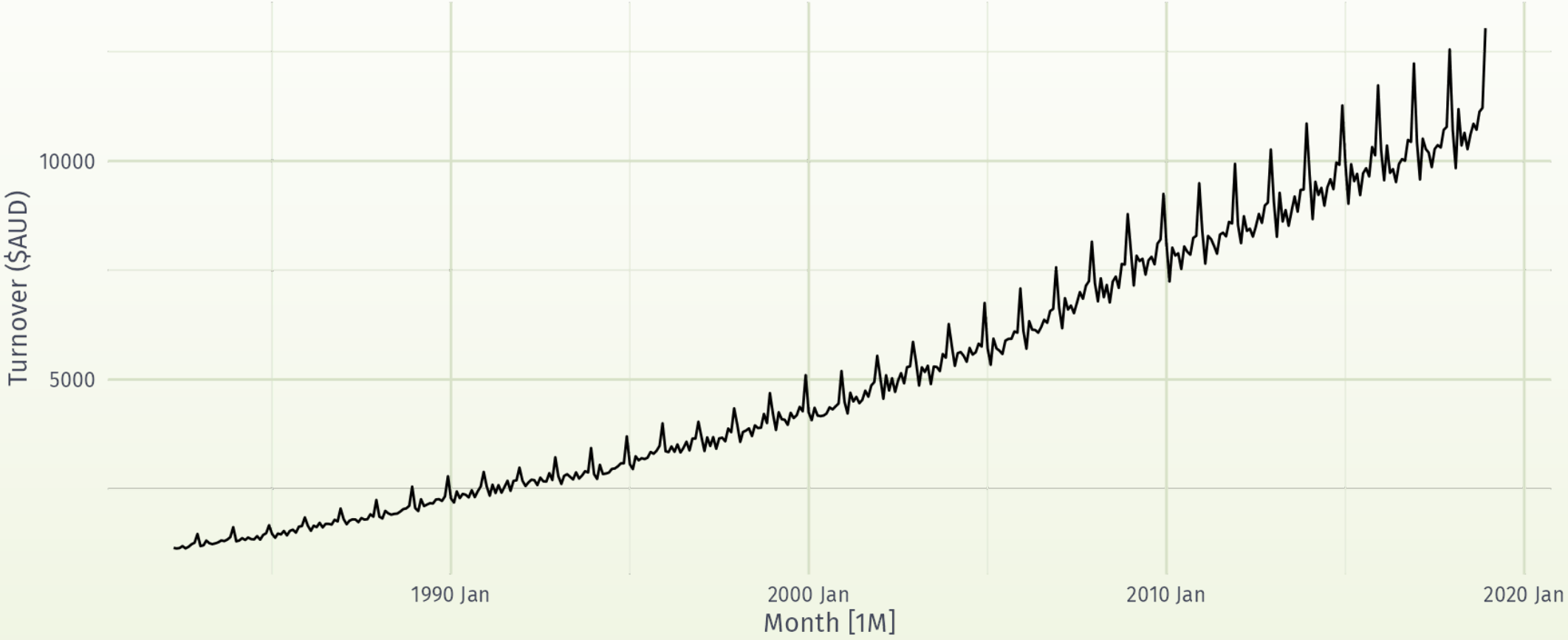
Mathematical transformations for stabilising variation

Square root	$w_t = \sqrt{y_t}$	$\downarrow$
Cube root	$w_t = \sqrt[3]{y_t}$	Increasing
Logarithm	$w_t = \log(y_t)$	strength

Logarithms, in particular, are useful because they are more interpretable: changes in a log value are **relative (percent) changes on the original scale**.

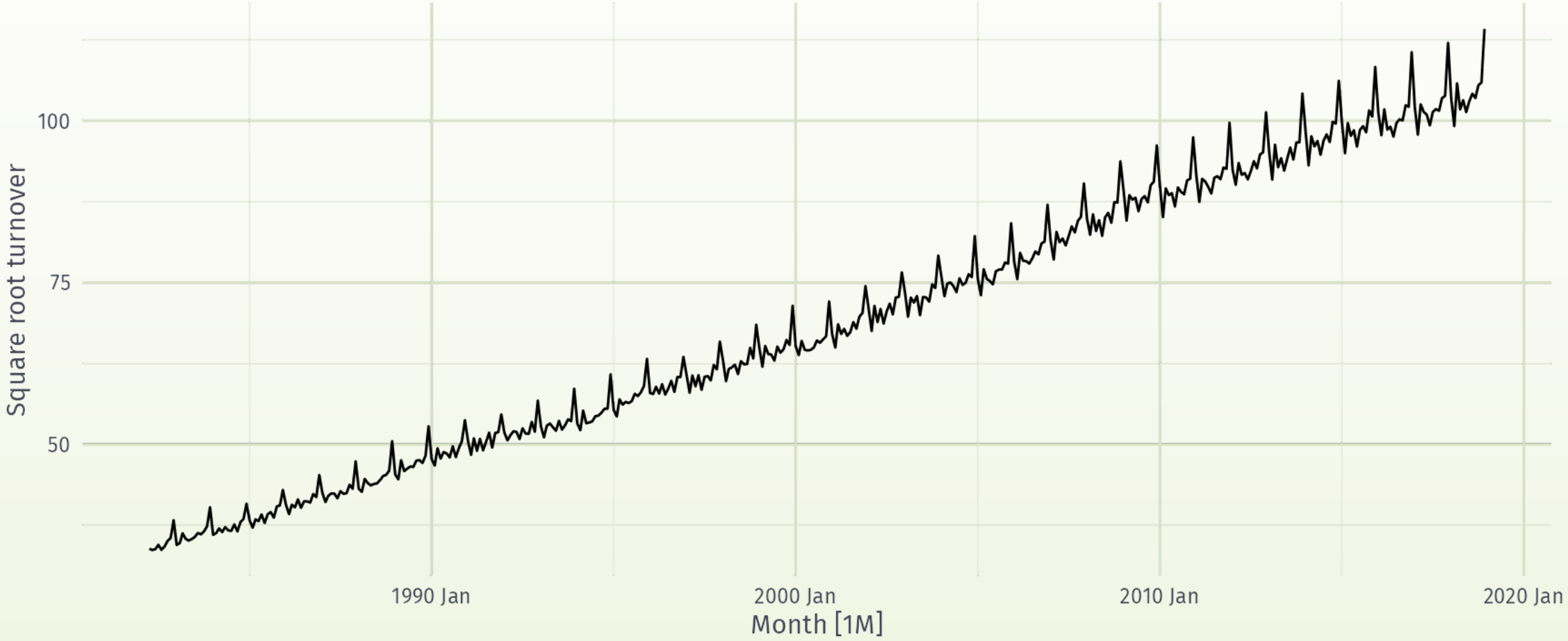
Variance stabilisation

```
food <- aus_retail |>
  filter(Industry == "Food retailing") |>
  summarise(Turnover = sum(Turnover))
```



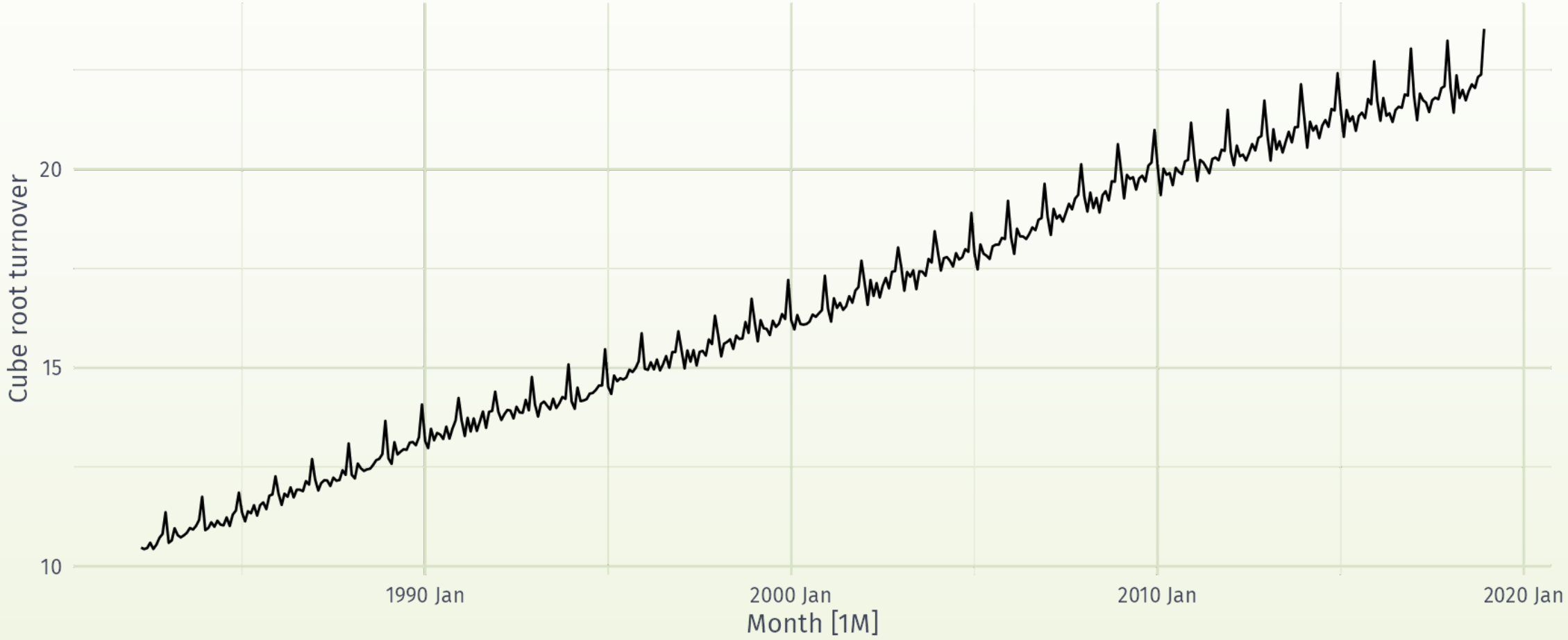
Variance stabilisation

```
food |> autoplot(sqrt(Turnover)) +
  labs(y = "Square root turnover")
```



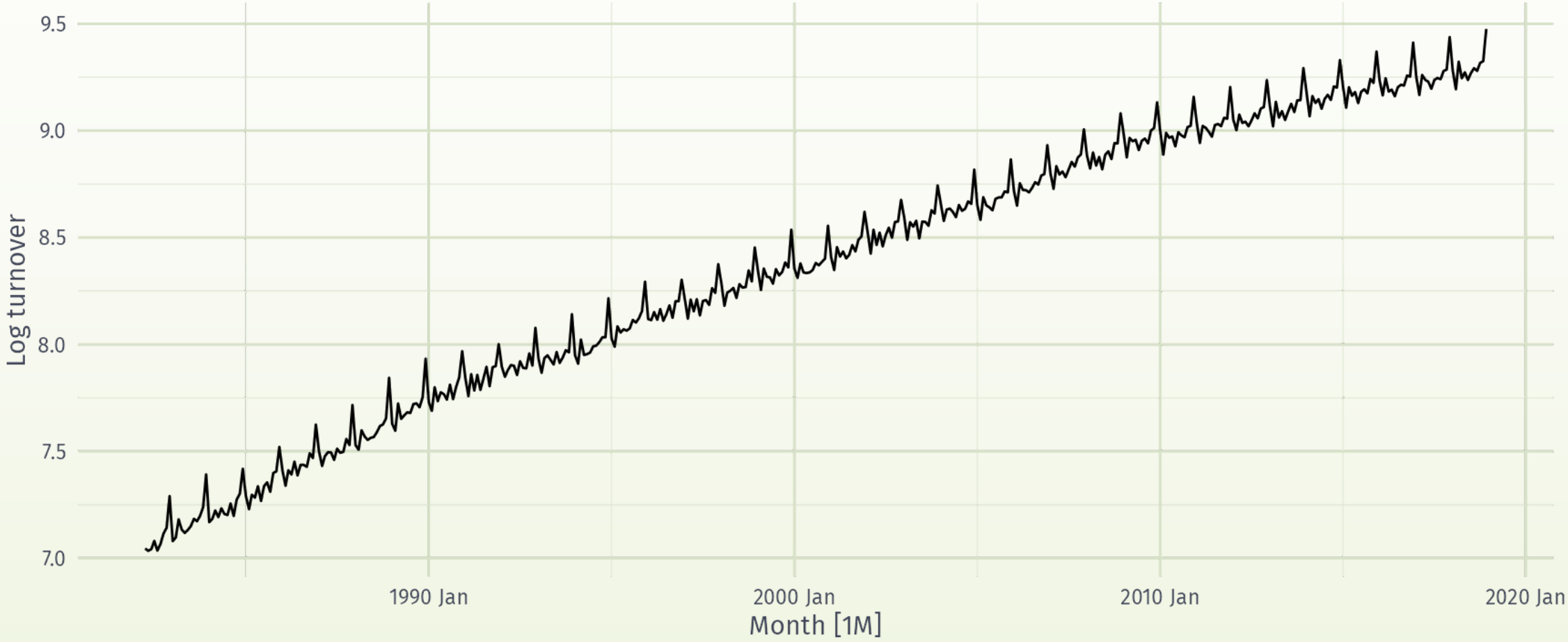
Variance stabilisation

```
food |> autoplot(Turnover^(1 / 3)) +
  labs(y = "Cube root turnover")
```



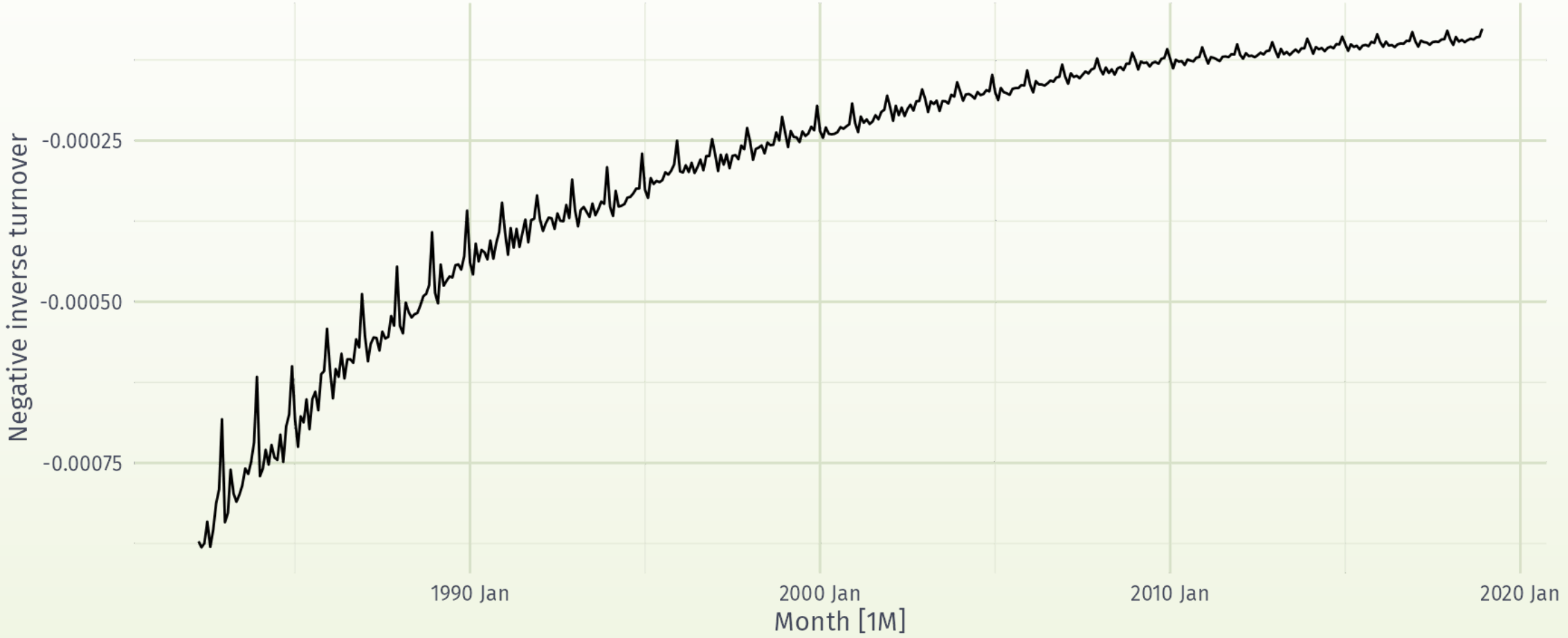
Variance stabilisation

```
food |> autoplot(log(Turnover)) +
  labs(y = "Log turnover")
```



Variance stabilisation

```
food |> autoplot(-1 / Turnover) +
  labs(y = "Negative inverse turnover")
```



Variance stabilisation

Which transformation best stabilises the variance of food turnover?

Square root	0	0%
Cube root	0	0%
Logarithm	0	0%
Inverse	0	0%

poll.nectric.com.au/s/
africast-transforming

0 responses

● CLOSED 0 connected

Box-Cox transformations

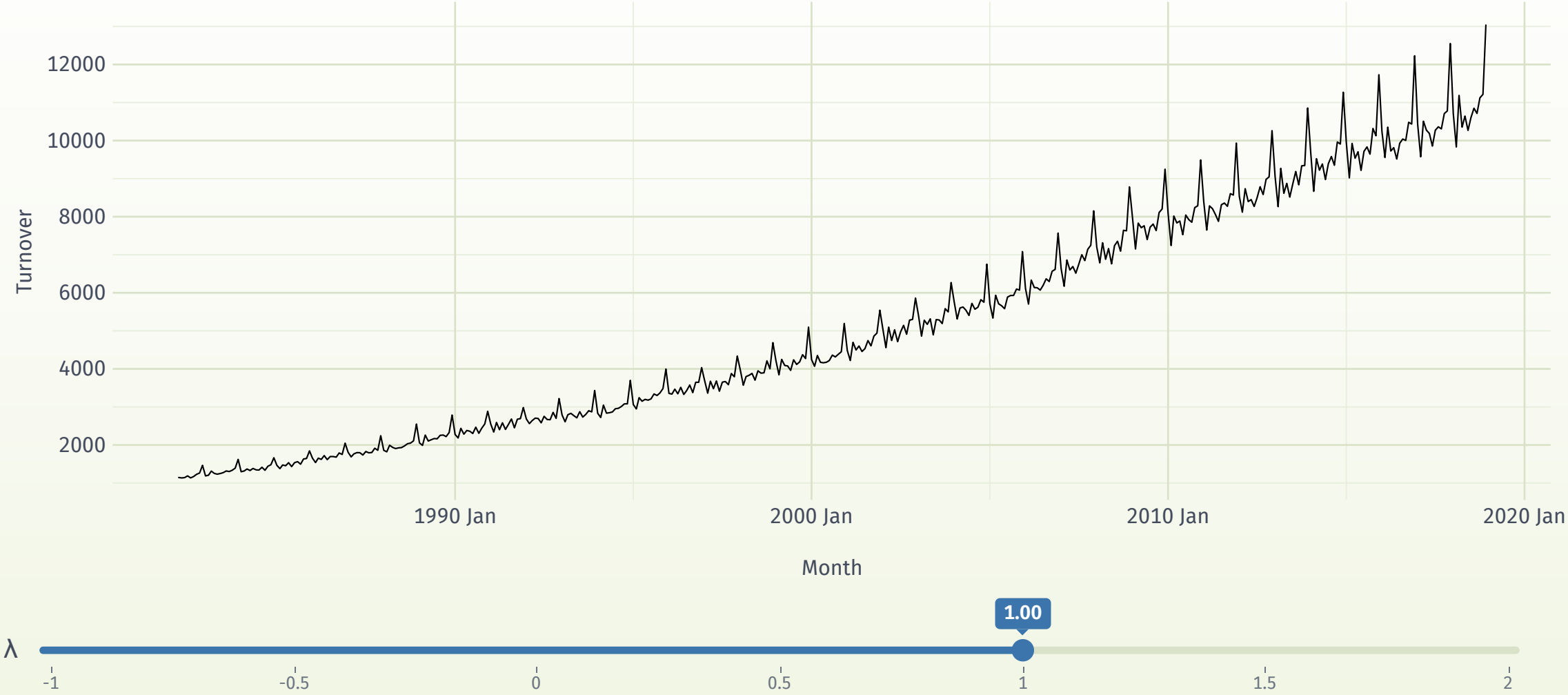
Each of these transformations is close to a member of the family of **Box-Cox transformations**:

$$w_t = \begin{cases} \log(y_t), & \lambda = 0; \\ (\text{sign}(y_t)|y_t|^\lambda - 1)/\lambda, & \lambda \neq 0. \end{cases}$$

- Actually the Bickel-Doksum transformation (allowing for $y_t < 0$)
- $\lambda = 1$: (No substantive transformation)
- $\lambda = \frac{1}{2}$: (Square root plus linear transformation)
- $\lambda = 0$: (Natural logarithm)
- $\lambda = -1$: (Negative inverse plus 1)

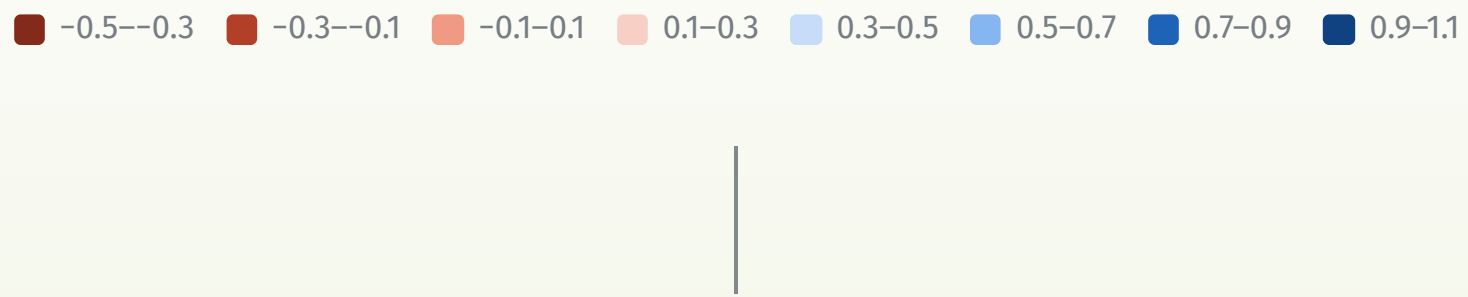
Box-Cox transformations

Box-Cox transformed food retailing turnover (λ = 1.00)



Box-Cox transformations

What is the best value of λ for food retailing turnover?



poll.nectric.com.au/s/
africast-transforming

0 responses

● CLOSED 0 connected

Box-Cox transformations

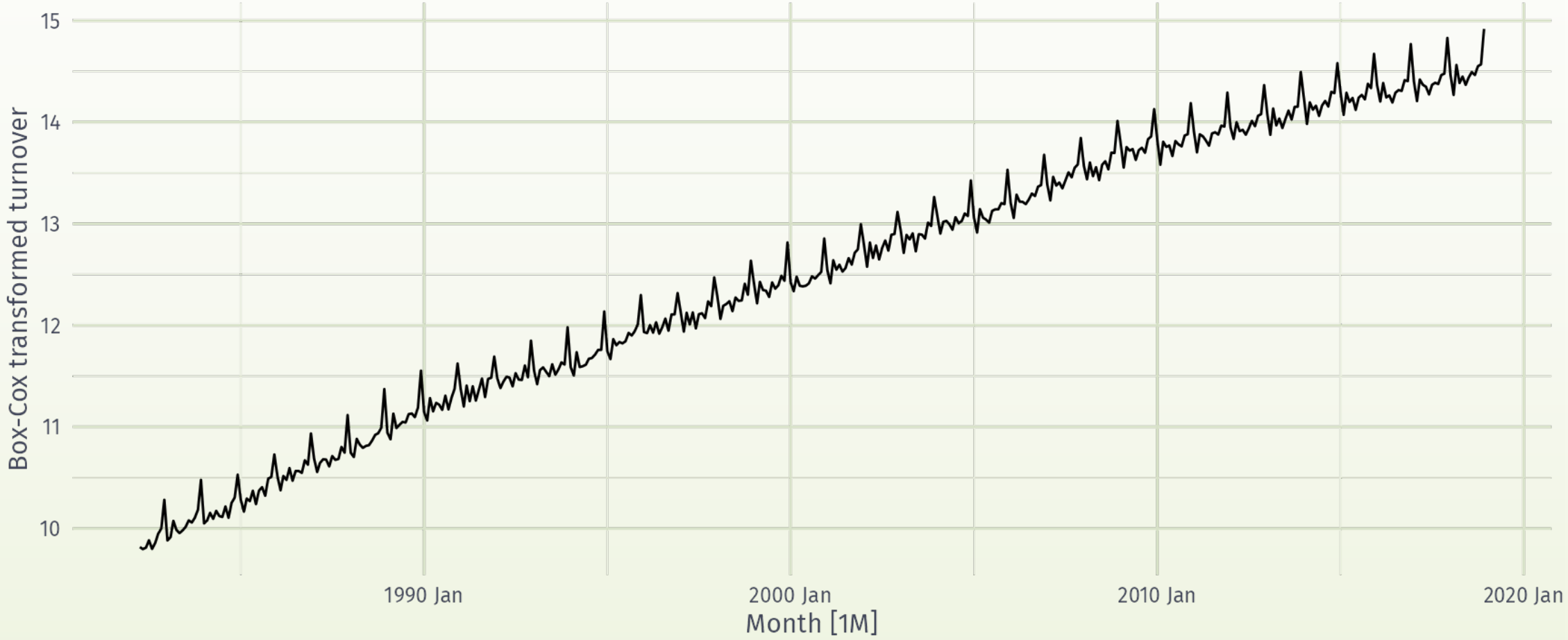
```
food |>
  features(Turnover, features = guerrero)
```

```
# A tibble: 1 × 1
  lambda_guerrero
            <dbl>
1          0.0895
```

- This attempts to balance the seasonal fluctuations and random variation across the series.
- Always check the results.
- A low value of λ can give extremely large prediction intervals.

Box-Cox transformations

```
food |> autoplot(box_cox(Turnover, 0.0895)) +
  labs(y = "Box-Cox transformed turnover")
```



Transformations

- Often no transformation needed.
- Simple transformations are easier to explain and work well enough.
- Transformations can have very large effect on PI.
- If some data are zero or negative, then use $\lambda > 0$.
- `log1p()` can also be useful for data with zeros.
- Choosing logs is a simple way to force forecasts to be positive
- Transformations must be reversed to obtain forecasts on the original scale. (Handled automatically by `fable`.)

SECTION 2 OF 5

Adjusting time series

1 Transforming time series
2 **Adjusting time series**
3 Time series decompositions
4 STL Features
5 Clustering features



Adjusting time series

Besides purely mathematical transformations, what adjustments could make a time series easier to forecast?

Waiting for answers...

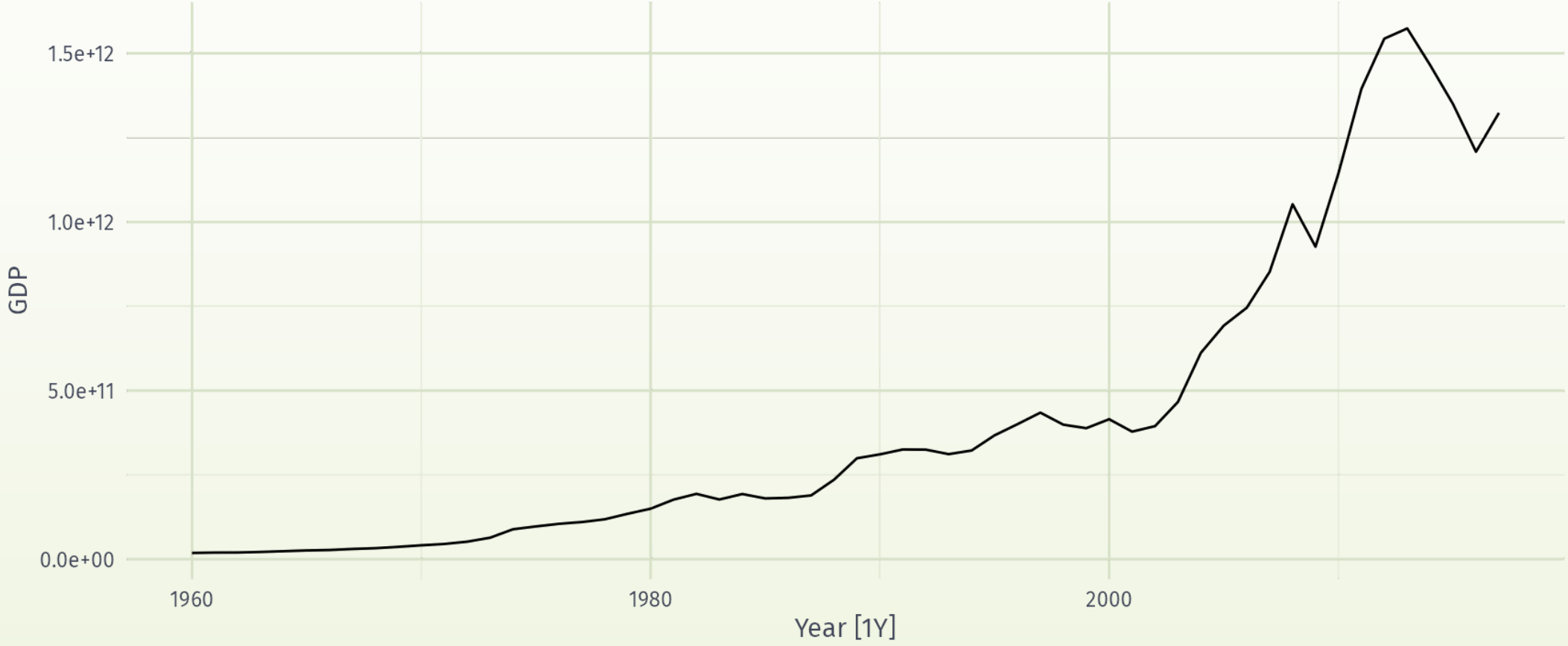
poll.nectric.com.au/s/
africast-transforming

0 responses

● CLOSED 0 connected

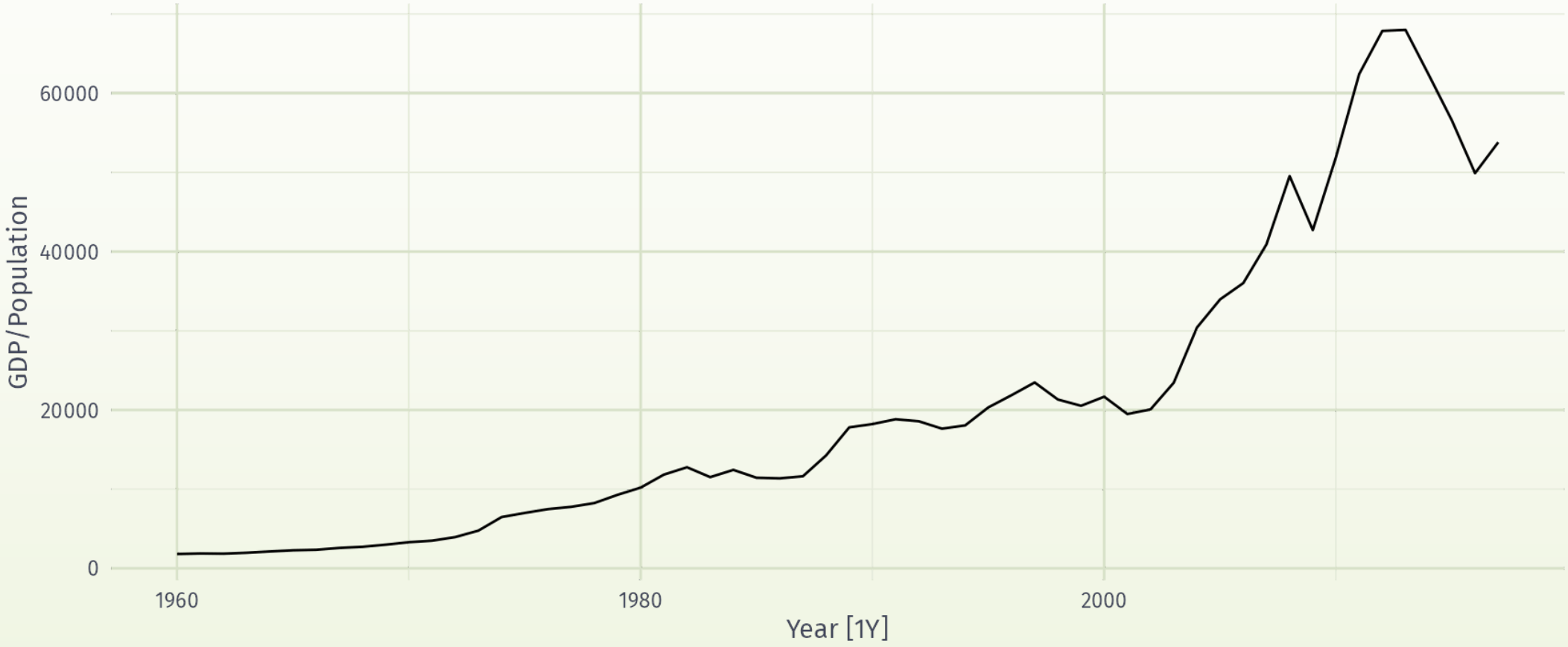
Per capita adjustments

```
global_economy |>
  filter(Country == "Australia") |>
  autoplot(GDP)
```



Per capita adjustments

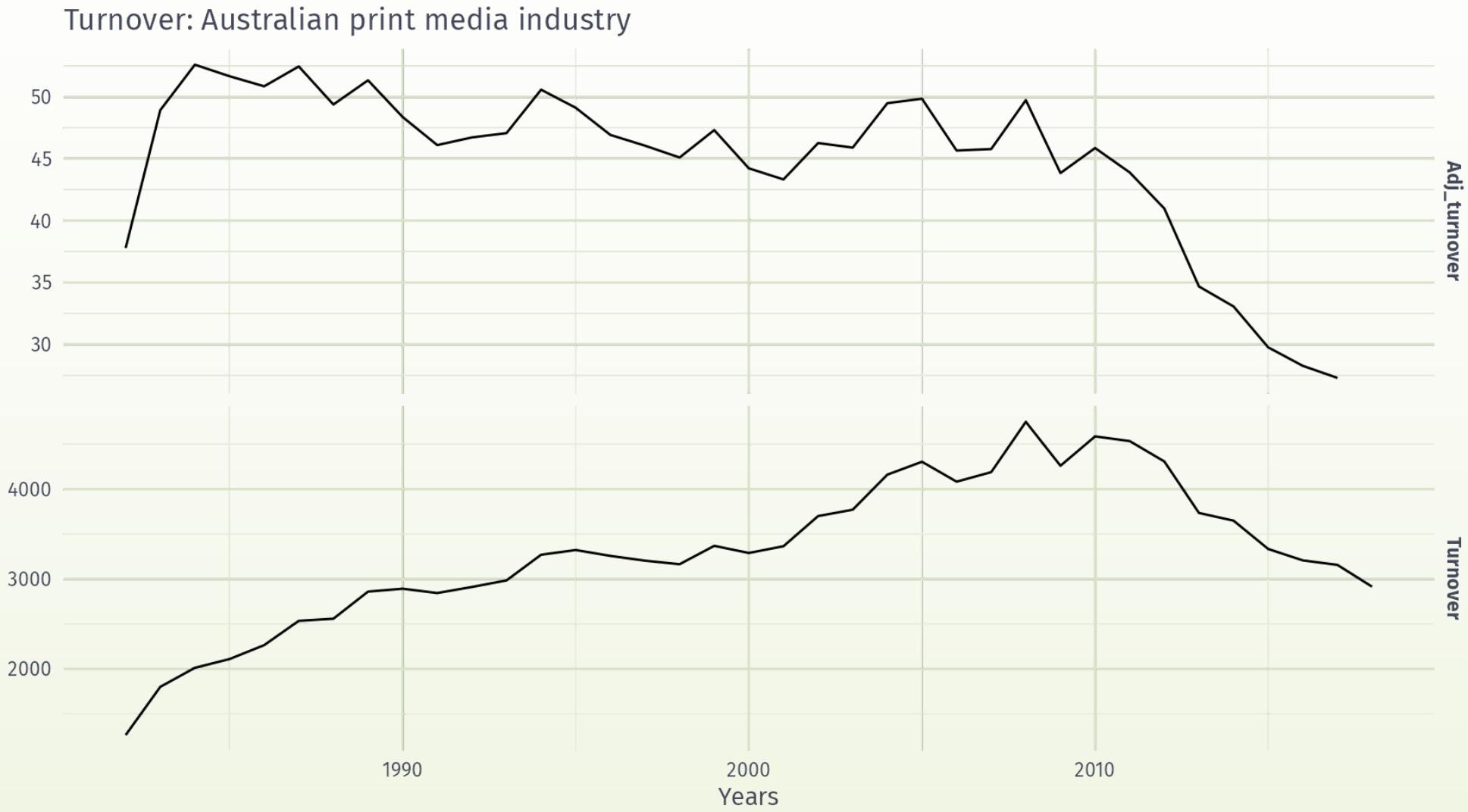
```
global_economy |>
  filter(Country == "Australia") |>
  autoplot(GDP / Population)
```



Inflation adjustments

```
print_retail <- aus_retail |>
  filter(Industry == "Newspaper and book retailing") |>
  group_by(Industry) |>
  index_by(Year = year(Month)) |>
  summarise(Turnover = sum(Turnover))
aus_economy <- filter(global_economy, Country == "Australia")
print_retail |>
  left_join(aus_economy, by = "Year") |>
  mutate(Adj_turnover = Turnover / CPI) |>
  pivot_longer(c(Turnover, Adj_turnover),
    names_to = "Type", values_to = "Turnover"
  ) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = Year, y = Turnover)) +
  geom_line() +
  facet_grid(vars(Type), scales = "free_y") +
  labs(x = "Years", y = NULL,
       title = "Turnover: Australian print media industry")
```

Inflation adjustments



SECTION 3 OF 5

Time series decompositions

1 Transforming time series
2 Adjusting time series
3 **Time series decompositions**
4 STL Features
5 Clustering features



Time series decomposition

Trend-Cycle

aperiodic changes in level over time.

Seasonal

(almost) periodic changes in level due to seasonal factors (e.g., the quarter of the year, the month, or day of the week).

Additive decomposition

$$y_t = S_t + T_t + R_t$$

where $y_t =$ data at period t

$T_t =$ trend-cycle component at period t

$S_t =$ seasonal component at period t

$R_t =$ remainder component at period t

STL decomposition

- STL: “Seasonal and Trend decomposition using Loess”
- Very versatile and robust.
- Seasonal component allowed to change over time, and rate of change controlled by user.
- Smoothness of trend-cycle also controlled by user.
- Optionally robust to outliers
- No trading day or calendar adjustments.
- Only additive.
- Take logs to get multiplicative decomposition.
- Use Box-Cox transformations to get other decompositions.

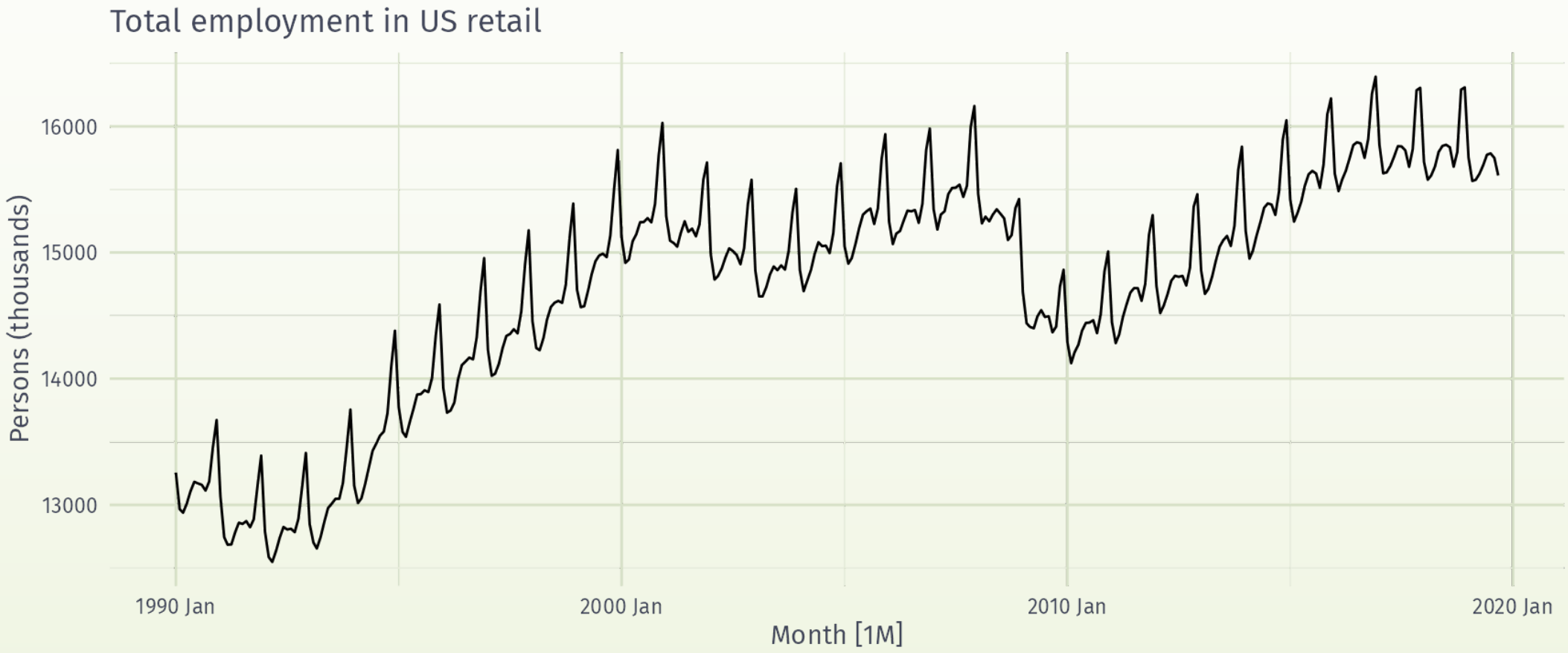
US Retail Employment

```
us_retail_employment <- us_employment |>
  filter(year(Month) >= 1990, Title == "Retail Trade") |>
  select(-Series_ID)
us_retail_employment
```

```
# A tsibble: 357 x 3 [1M]
      Month Title        Employed
      <mth> <chr>           <dbl>
 1 1990 Jan Retail Trade   13256.
 2 1990 Feb Retail Trade   12966.
 3 1990 Mar Retail Trade   12938.
 4 1990 Apr Retail Trade   13012.
 5 1990 May Retail Trade   13108.
 6 1990 Jun Retail Trade   13183.
 7 1990 Jul Retail Trade   13170.
 8 1990 Aug Retail Trade   13160.
 9 1990 Sep Retail Trade   13113.
10 1990 Oct Retail Trade   13185.
# i 347 more rows
```

US Retail Employment

```
us_retail_employment |>
  autoplot(Employed) +
  labs(y = "Persons (thousands)", title = "Total employment in US retail")
```



US Retail Employment

```
dcmp <- us_retail_employment |>
  model(stl = STL(Employed))
dcmp
```

```
# A mable: 1 x 1
      stl
  <model>
1   <STL>
```

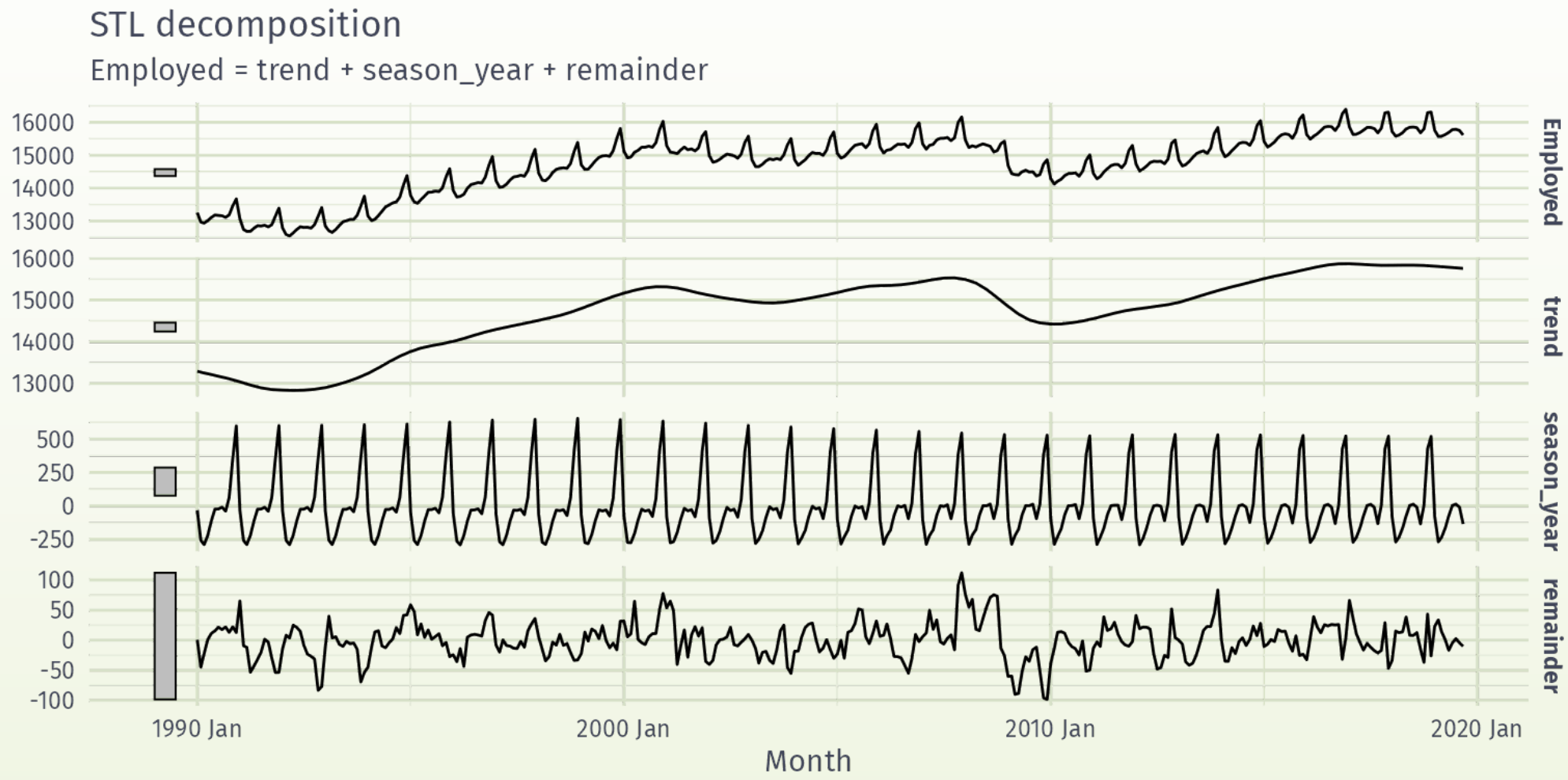
US Retail Employment

```
components(dcmp)
```

```
# A dable: 357 x 7 [1M]
# Key:     .model [1]
# :        Employed = trend + season_year + remainder
   .model    Month Employed  trend season_year remainder season_adjust
   <chr>     <mth>    <dbl>  <dbl>       <dbl>     <dbl>         <dbl>
 1 stl    1990 Jan   13256. 13288.      -33.0      0.836        13289.
 2 stl    1990 Feb   12966. 13269.     -258.     -44.6          13224.
 3 stl    1990 Mar   12938. 13250.     -290.     -22.1          13228.
 4 stl    1990 Apr   13012. 13231.     -220.       1.05         13232.
 5 stl    1990 May   13108. 13211.     -114.      11.3          13223.
 6 stl    1990 Jun   13183. 13192.      -24.3     15.5          13207.
 7 stl    1990 Jul   13170. 13172.      -23.2     21.6          13193.
 8 stl    1990 Aug   13160. 13151.       -9.52    17.8          13169.
 9 stl    1990 Sep   13113. 13131.      -39.5     22.0          13153.
10 stl    1990 Oct   13185. 13110.       61.6     13.2          13124.
# i 347 more rows
```

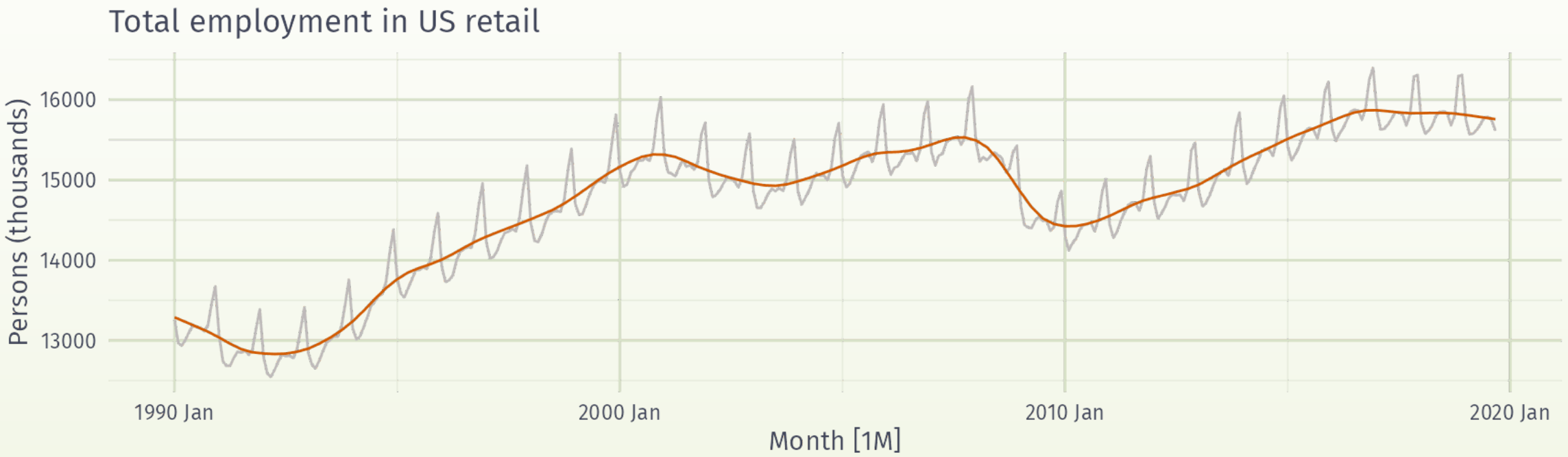
US Retail Employment

```
components(dcmp) |> autoplot()
```



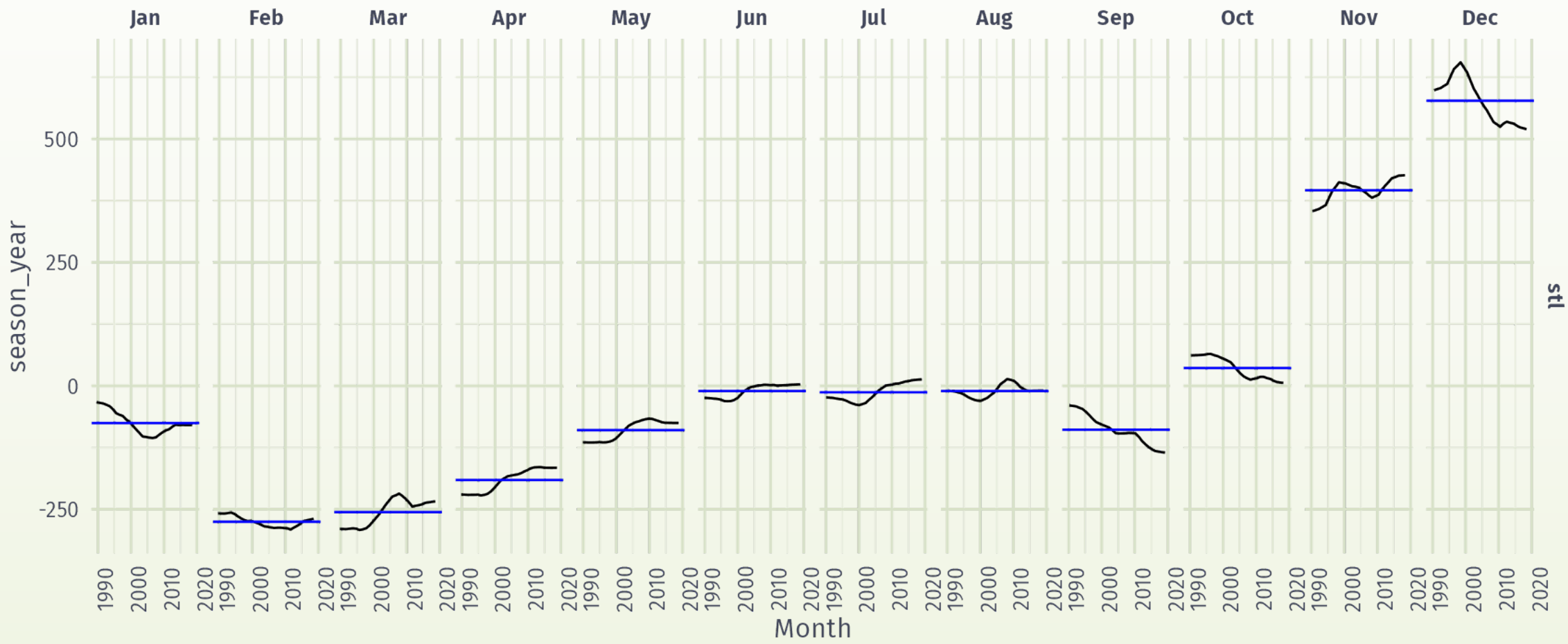
US Retail Employment

```
us_retail_employment |>
  autoplot(Employed, color = "gray") +
  autolayer(components(dcmp), trend, color = "#D55E00") +
  labs(y = "Persons (thousands)", title = "Total employment in US retail")
```



US Retail Employment

```
components(dcmp) |> gg_subseries(season_year)
```



US Retail Employment

In which month does US retail employment peak?

March	0	0%
July	0	0%
October	0	0%
December	0	0%

poll.nectric.com.au/s/
africast-transforming

0 responses

● CLOSED 0 connected

US Retail Employment

How is the December peak in US retail employment changing over time?

Getting larger	0	0%
Getting smaller	0	0%
Staying the same	0	0%
Grew, then shrank	0	0%

poll.nectric.com.au/s/africast-transforming

0 responses

CLOSED 0 connected

Seasonal adjustment

- Useful by-product of decomposition: an easy way to calculate seasonally adjusted data.
- Additive decomposition: seasonally adjusted data given by

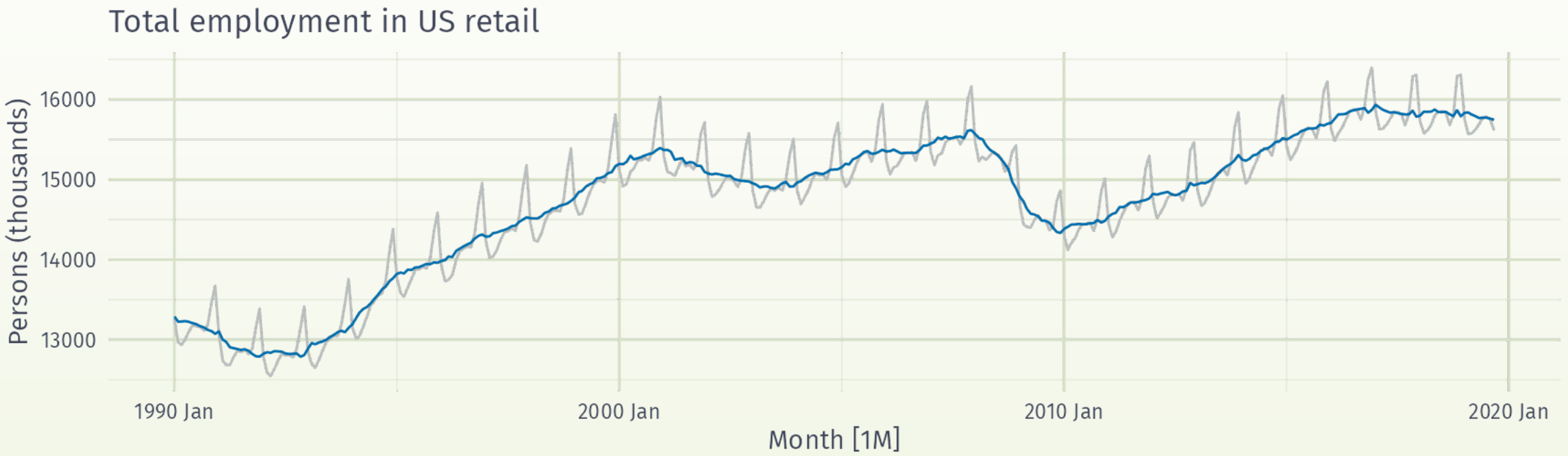
$$y_t - S_t = T_t + R_t$$

- Multiplicative decomposition: seasonally adjusted data given by

$$y_t / S_t = T_t \times R_t$$

US Retail Employment

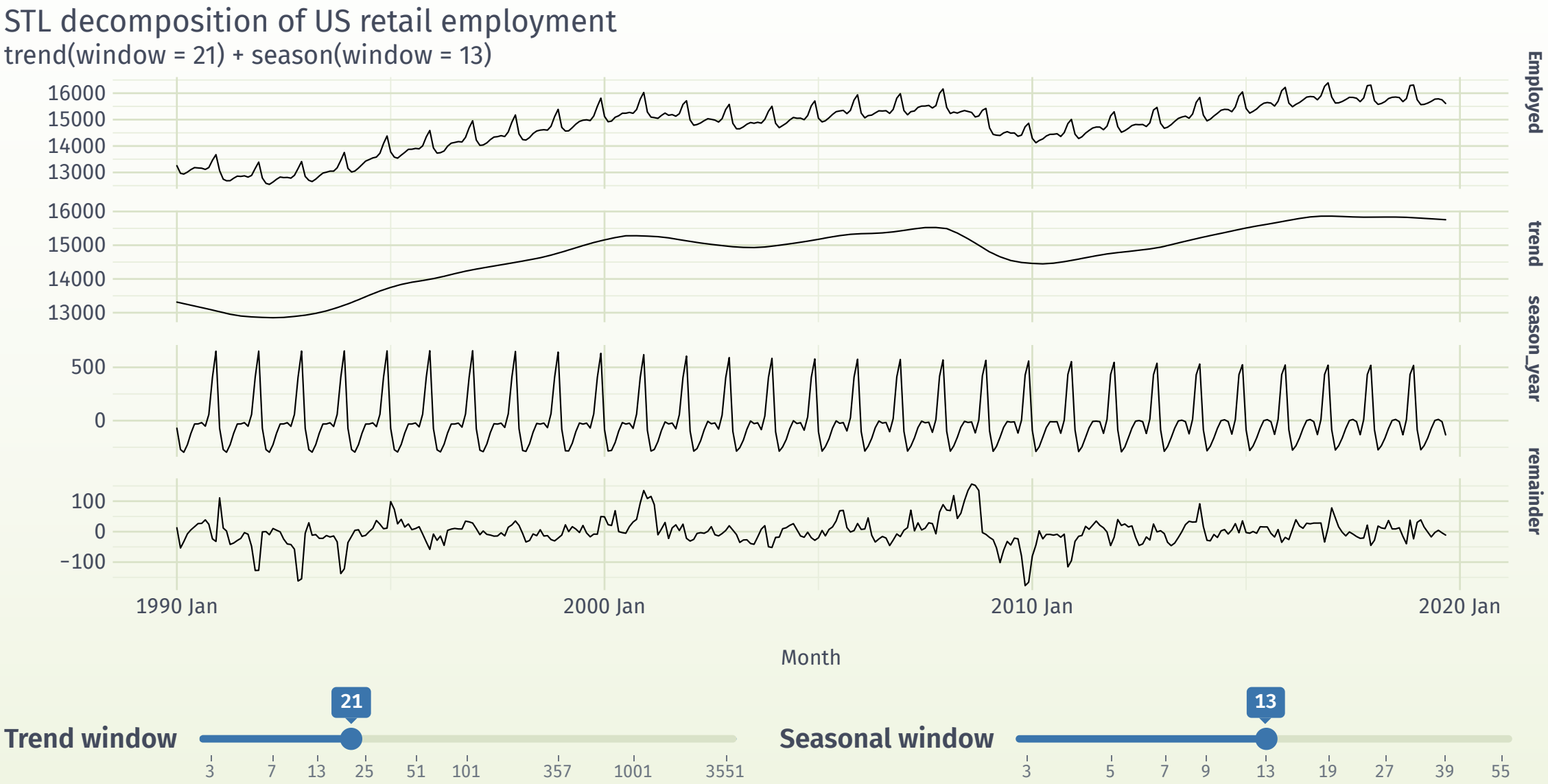
```
us_retail_employment |>
  autoplot(Employed, color = "gray") +
  autolayer(components(dcmp), season_adjust, color = "#0072B2") +
  labs(y = "Persons (thousands)", title = "Total employment in US retail")
```



Seasonal adjustment

- We use estimates of S based on past values to seasonally adjust a current value.
- Seasonally adjusted series reflect **remainders** as well as **trend**. Therefore they are not “smooth” and “downturns” or “upturns” can be misleading.
- It is better to use the trend-cycle component to look for turning points.

STL decomposition



STL decomposition

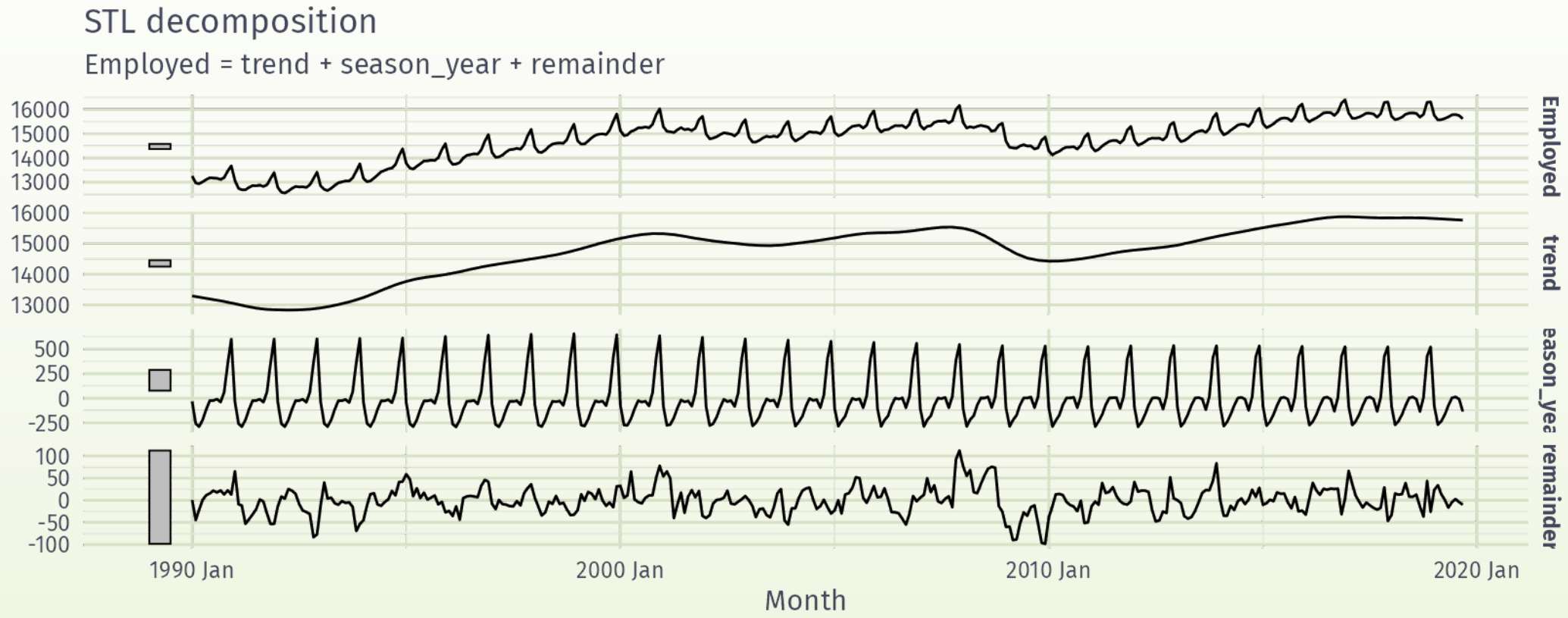
```
us_retail_employment |>
  model(STL(Employed ~ trend(window = 15) + season(window = "periodic"),
    robust = TRUE
  )) |>
  components()
```

- `trend(window = ?)` controls wiggliness of trend component.
- `season(window = ?)` controls variation on seasonal component.
- `season(window = 'periodic')` is equivalent to an infinite window.

STL decomposition

```
us_retail_employment |>
  model(STL(Employed)) |>
  components() |>
  autoplot()
```

- `STL()` chooses `season(window=13)` by default
- Can include transformations.

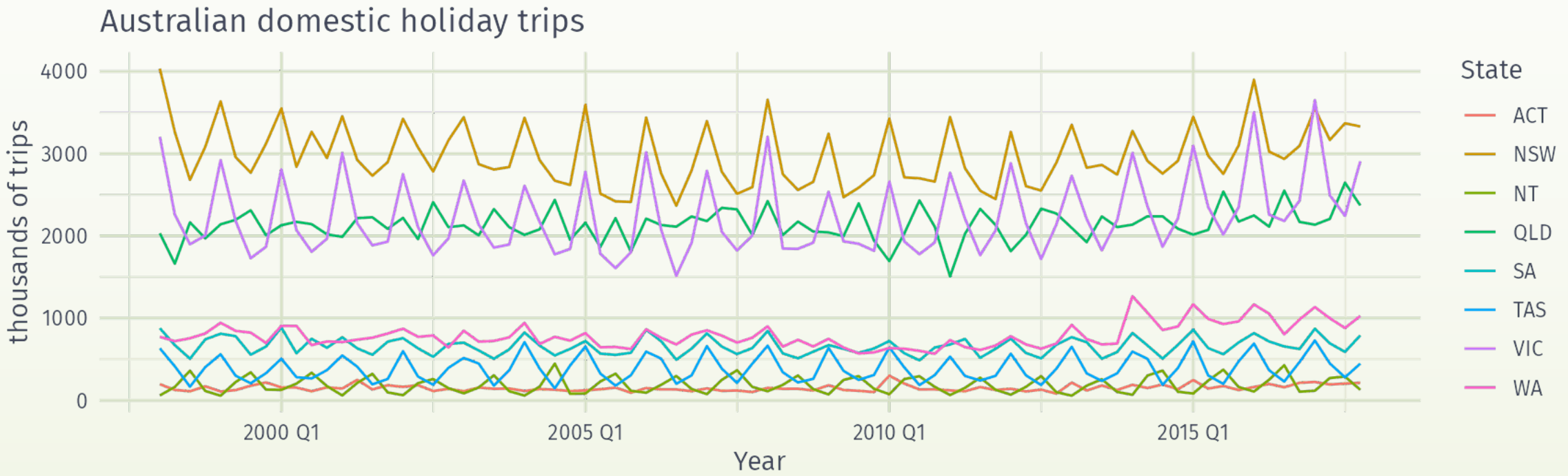


STL decomposition

- Algorithm that updates trend and seasonal components iteratively.
- Starts with $\hat{T}_t = 0$
- Uses a mixture of loess and moving averages to successively refine the trend and seasonal estimates.
- trend window controls loess bandwidth on deseasonalised values.
- season window controls loess bandwidth on detrended subseries.
- Robustness weights based on remainder.
- Default season: `window = 13`
- Default trend: `window = nextodd(ceiling((1.5*period)/(1-(1.5/s.window))))`
- `window` values should be odd numbers for symmetry.

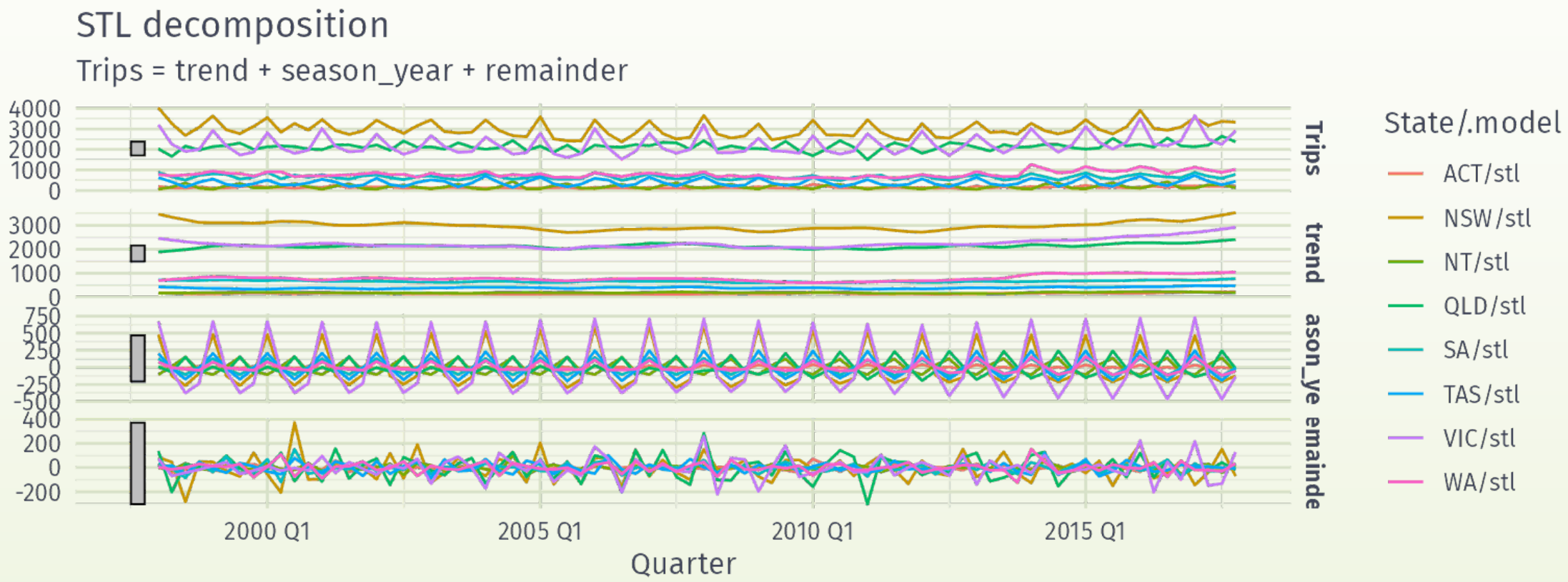
Australian holidays

```
holidays |> autoplot(Trips) +
  labs(y = "thousands of trips", x = "Year",
       title = "Australian domestic holiday trips")
```



Australian holidays

```
holidays |>
  model(stl = STL(Trips)) |>
  components() |>
  autoplot()
```



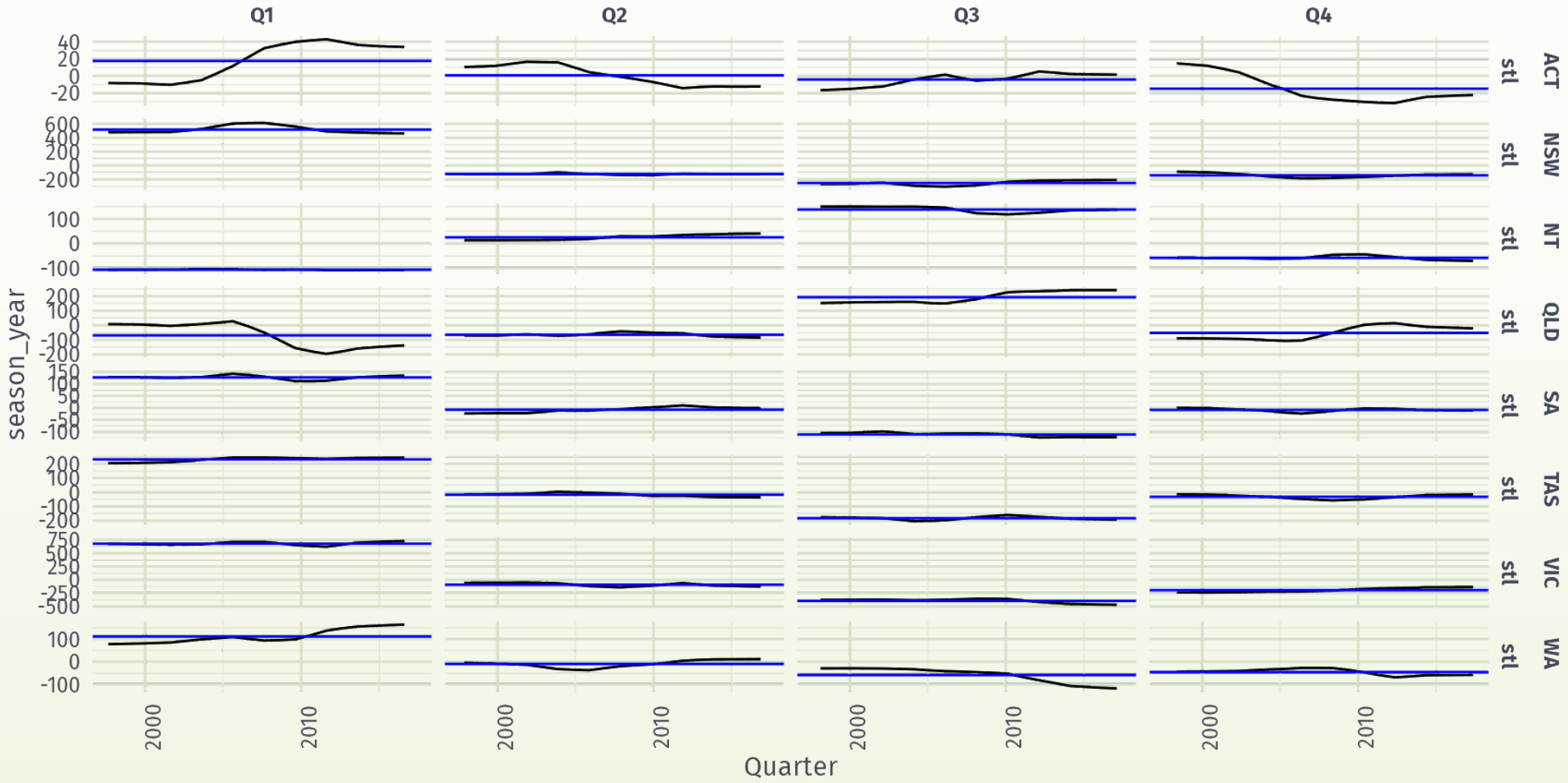
Holidays decomposition

```
dcmp <- holidays |>
  model(stl = STL(Trips)) |>
  components()
dcmp
```

```
# A dable: 640 x 8 [1Q]
# Key:     State, .model [8]
# :        Trips = trend + season_year + remainder
   State .model Quarter Trips trend season_year remainder season_adjust
   <chr> <chr>    <qtr> <dbl> <dbl>       <dbl>     <dbl>          <dbl>
 1 ACT   stl    1998 Q1  196.  172.       -8.48     32.6            205.
 2 ACT   stl    1998 Q2  127.  157.       10.3     -40.6            116.
 3 ACT   stl    1998 Q3  111.  142.      -16.8     -14.5            128.
 4 ACT   stl    1998 Q4  170.  130.       14.6      25.6            156.
 5 ACT   stl    1999 Q1  108.  135.       -8.63    -18.3            116.
 6 ACT   stl    1999 Q2  125.  148.       11.0     -34.6            114.
 7 ACT   stl    1999 Q3  178.  166.      -16.0      28.3            194.
 8 ACT   stl    1999 Q4  218.  177.       13.2      27.5            204.
 9 ACT   stl    2000 Q1  158.  169.       -8.75     -1.96           167.
10 ACT   stl    2000 Q2  155.  151.       11.7      -8.20           143.
# i 630 more rows
```

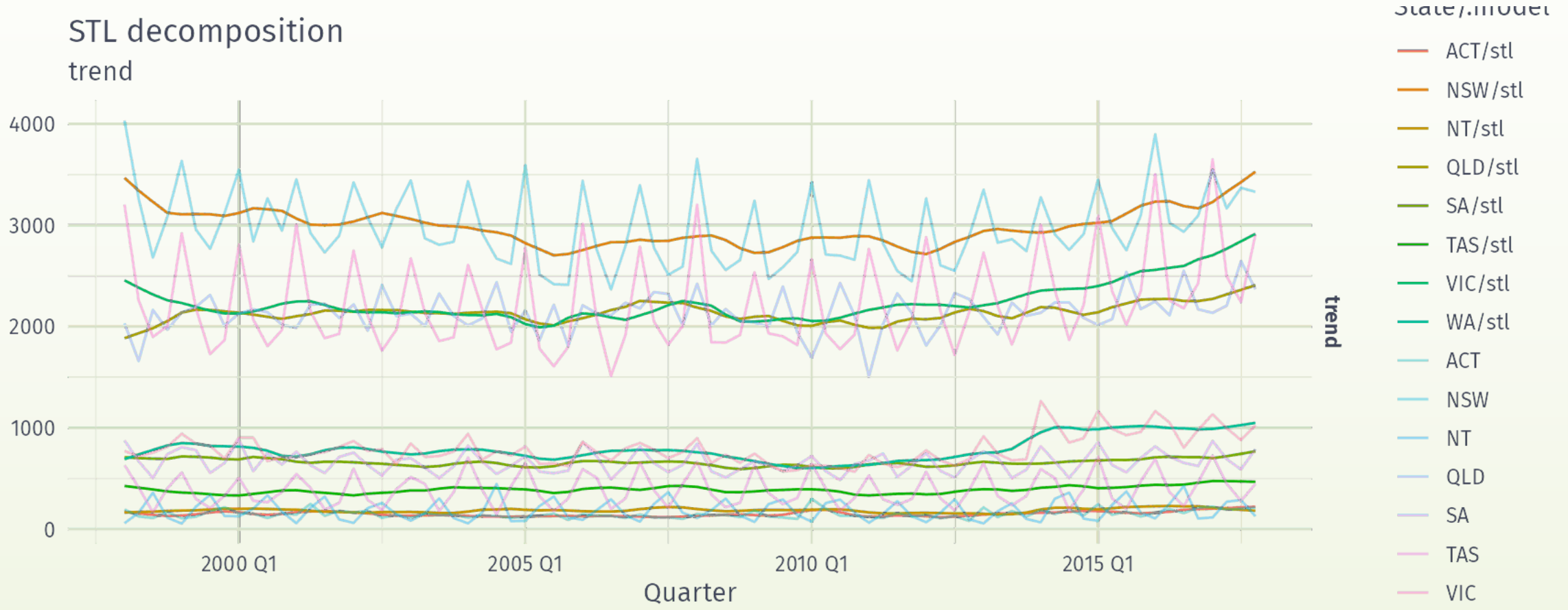
Holidays decomposition

```
dcmp |> gg_subseries(season_year)
```



Holidays decomposition

```
autoplot(dcmp, trend, scale_bars = FALSE) +
  autolayer(holidays, alpha = 0.4)
```



SECTION 4 OF 5

STL Features

1 Transforming time series
2 Adjusting time series
3 Time series decompositions
4 **STL Features**
5 Clustering features



Strength of seasonality and trend

STL decomposition

$$y_t = T_t + S_t + R_t$$

Seasonal strength

$$\max\left(0, 1 - \frac{\text{Var}(R_t)}{\text{Var}(S_t + R_t)}\right)$$

Trend strength

$$\max\left(0, 1 - \frac{\text{Var}(R_t)}{\text{Var}(T_t + R_t)}\right)$$

Both range from 0 (none) to 1 (strong), computed by `feat_stl()`.

STL features

`tourism`: quarterly overnight trips (thousands) for 304 Australian domestic series, keyed by Region, State and Purpose.

```
tourism |> features(Trips, feat_stl)
```

```
# A tibble: 304 × 12
   Region         State Purpose trend_strength seasonal_strength_year seasonal_peak_year
   <chr>          <chr> <chr>             <dbl>                  <dbl>              <dbl>
 1 Adelaide       SA    Busine…           0.464                  0.407                  3
 2 Adelaide       SA    Holiday           0.554                  0.619                  1
 3 Adelaide       SA    Other             0.746                  0.202                  2
 4 Adelaide       SA    Visiti…           0.435                  0.452                  1
 5 Adelaide Hills SA    Busine…           0.464                  0.179                  3
 6 Adelaide Hills SA    Holiday           0.528                  0.296                  2
 7 Adelaide Hills SA    Other             0.593                  0.404                  2
 8 Adelaide Hills SA    Visiti…           0.488                  0.254                  0
 9 Alice Springs  NT    Busine…           0.534                  0.251                  0
10 Alice Springs  NT    Holiday           0.381                  0.832                  3
# ℹ 294 more rows
# ℹ 6 more variables: seasonal_trough_year <dbl>, spikiness <dbl>, linearity <dbl>,
#   curvature <dbl>, stl_e_acf1 <dbl>, stl_e_acf10 <dbl>
```

STL features

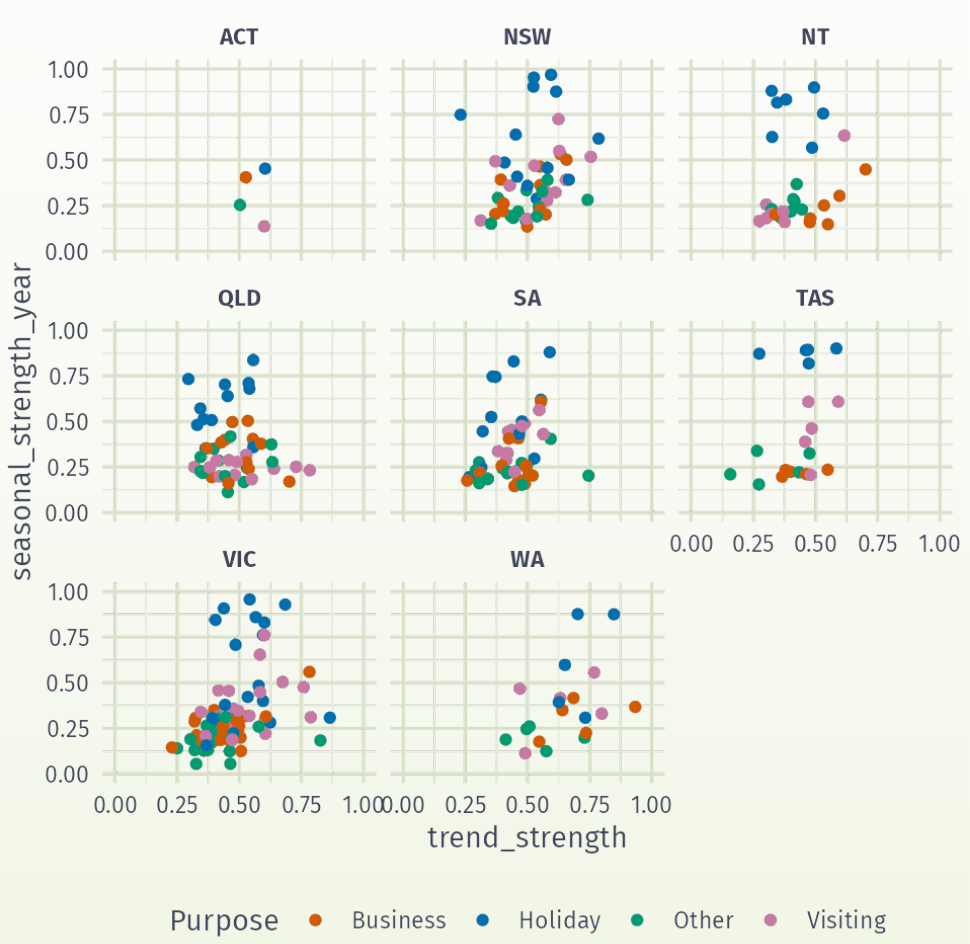
- `trend_strength`, `seasonal_strength_year`: strength of the trend and seasonal components.
- `seasonal_peak_year`, `seasonal_trough_year`: the quarter with the largest and smallest seasonal component.
- `spikiness`: prevalence of spikes in the remainder.
- `linearity`, `curvature`: shape of the trend, from a quadratic regression on time.
- `stl_e_acf1`: first autocorrelation of the remainder.
- `stl_e_acf10`: sum of squares of the first ten autocorrelations of the remainder.

Seasonal and trend strength

```
tourism |>
  features(Trips, feat_stl) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = trend_strength, y = seasonal_strength_year, col = Purpose)) +
  geom_point() + facet_wrap(vars(State)) +
  coord_cartesian(xlim = c(0, 1), ylim = c(0, 1))
```



Seasonal and trend strength



Which travel purpose is most seasonal?

Business	0	0%
Holiday	0	0%
Other	0	0%
Visiting	0	0%

poll.nectric.com.au/s/africast-transforming

0 responses

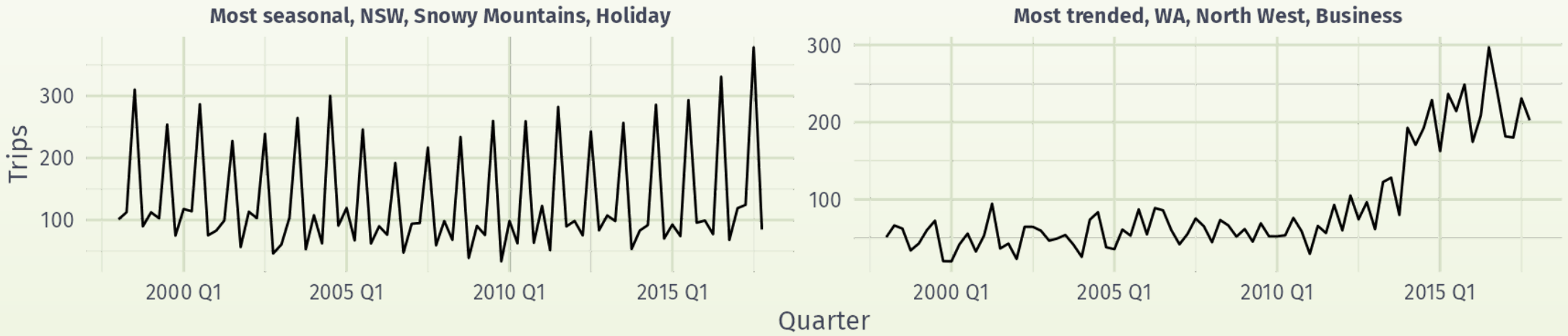
CLOSED 0 connected

- Holidays more seasonal than other travel.

Most seasonal and most trended series

```
stl_features <- tourism |> features(Trips, feat_stl)
extremes <- bind_rows(
  "Most seasonal" = slice_max(stl_features, seasonal_strength_year),
  "Most trended" = slice_max(stl_features, trend_strength),
  .id = "Feature"
)
```

```
tourism |>
  inner_join(extremes, by = join_by(State, Region, Purpose)) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = Quarter, y = Trips)) +
  geom_line() +
  facet_wrap(vars(Feature, State, Region, Purpose), scales = "free_y",
    labeller = labeller(.multi_line = FALSE))
```



ACF features

```
tourism |> features(Trips, feat_acf)
```

```
# A tibble: 304 × 10
   Region      State Purpose     acf1 acf10 diff1_acf1 diff1_acf10 diff2_acf1 diff2_acf10
   <chr>       <chr> <chr>      <dbl> <dbl>      <dbl>       <dbl>      <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 Adelaide    SA    Busine…  0.0333  0.131     -0.520       0.463     -0.676       0.741
 2 Adelaide    SA    Holiday  0.0456  0.372     -0.343       0.614     -0.487       0.558
 3 Adelaide    SA    Other    0.517   1.15      -0.409       0.383     -0.675       0.792
 4 Adelaide    SA    Visiti…  0.0684  0.294     -0.394       0.452     -0.518       0.447
 5 Adelaide …  SA    Busine…  0.0709  0.134     -0.580       0.415     -0.750       0.746
 6 Adelaide …  SA    Holiday  0.131   0.313     -0.536       0.500     -0.716       0.906
 7 Adelaide …  SA    Other    0.261   0.330     -0.253       0.317     -0.457       0.392
 8 Adelaide …  SA    Visiti…  0.139   0.117     -0.472       0.239     -0.626       0.408
 9 Alice Spr…  NT    Busine…  0.217   0.367     -0.500       0.381     -0.658       0.587
10 Alice Spr…  NT    Holiday -0.00660 2.11      -0.153       2.11      -0.274       1.55
# i 294 more rows
# i 1 more variable: season_acf1 <dbl>
```

ACF features

- `acf1`: first autocorrelation of the series.
- `acf10`: sum of squares of the first ten autocorrelations.
- `diff1_acf1`, `diff1_acf10`: the same, for the differenced series.
- `diff2_acf1`, `diff2_acf10`: the same, for the twice differenced series.
- `season_acf1`: autocorrelation at the first seasonal lag.

SECTION 5 OF 5

Clustering features

1 Transforming time series
2 Adjusting time series
3 Time series decompositions
4 STL Features
5 **Clustering features**



All feasts features

All features from the feasts package:

```
tourism_features <- tourism |>
  features(Trips, feature_set(pkgs = "feasts"))
tourism_features
```

```
# A tibble: 304 × 51
   Region         State Purpose trend_strength seasonal_strength_year seasonal_peak_year
   <chr>          <chr> <chr>             <dbl>                  <dbl>               <dbl>
 1 Adelaide       SA    Busine…           0.464                  0.407                   3
 2 Adelaide       SA    Holiday           0.554                  0.619                   1
 3 Adelaide       SA    Other             0.746                  0.202                   2
 4 Adelaide       SA    Visiti…           0.435                  0.452                   1
 5 Adelaide Hills SA    Busine…           0.464                  0.179                   3
 6 Adelaide Hills SA    Holiday           0.528                  0.296                   2
 7 Adelaide Hills SA    Other             0.593                  0.404                   2
 8 Adelaide Hills SA    Visiti…           0.488                  0.254                   0
 9 Alice Springs  NT    Busine…           0.534                  0.251                   0
10 Alice Springs  NT    Holiday           0.381                  0.832                   3
# i 294 more rows
# i 45 more variables: seasonal_trough_year <dbl>, spikiness <dbl>, linearity <dbl>,
#   curvature <dbl>, stl_e_acf1 <dbl>, stl_e_acf10 <dbl>, acf1 <dbl>, acf10 <dbl>,
#   diff1_acf1 <dbl>, diff1_acf10 <dbl>, diff2_acf1 <dbl>, diff2_acf10 <dbl>,
#   season_acf1 <dbl>, pacf5 <dbl>, diff1_pacf5 <dbl>, diff2_pacf5 <dbl>,
#   season_pacf <dbl>, zero_run_mean <dbl>, nonzero_squared_cv <dbl>,
#   zero_start_prop <dbl>, zero_end_prop <dbl>, lambda_guerrero <dbl>, …
```

Principal components

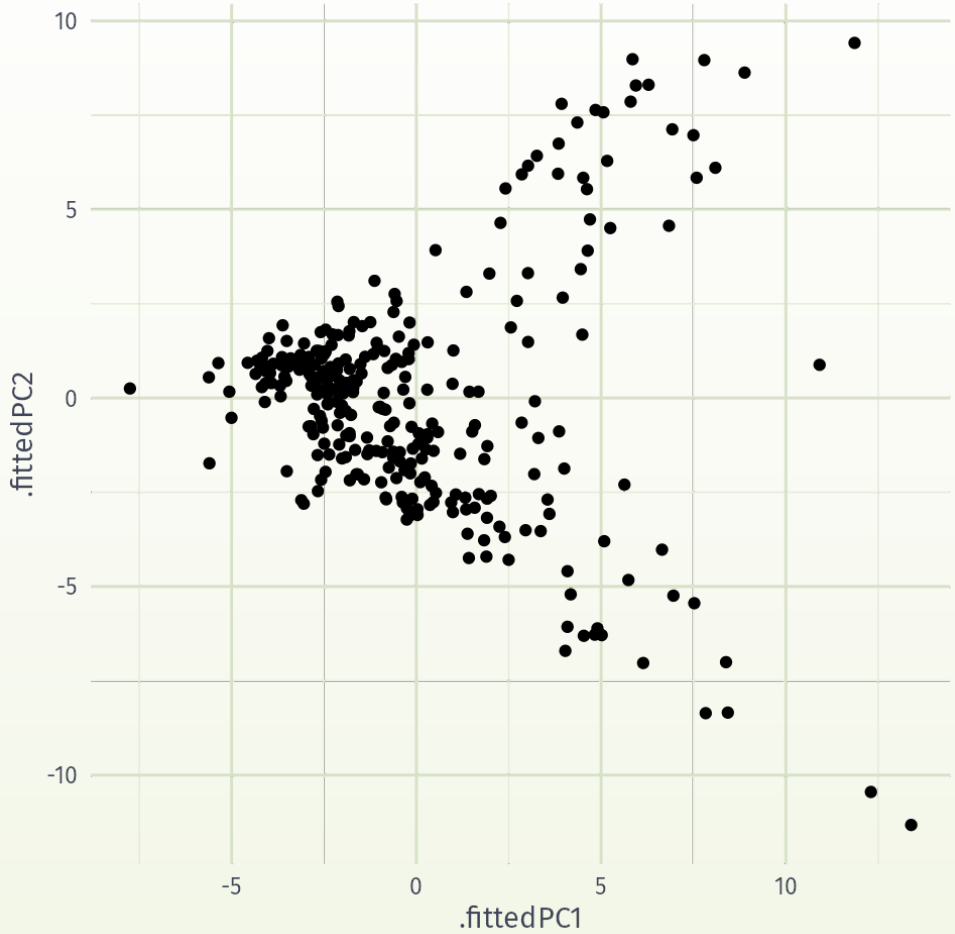
Principal components are combinations of the 48 features with the most variation, so the 304 series can be compared in two dimensions:

```
pcs <- tourism_features |>
  select(-State, -Region, -Purpose) |>
  prcomp(scale. = TRUE) |>
  broom::augment(tourism_features)
pcs |> select(Region, State, Purpose, .fittedPC1, .fittedPC2)
```

```
# A tibble: 304 × 5
   Region         State Purpose  .fittedPC1 .fittedPC2
   <chr>          <chr> <chr>         <dbl>      <dbl>
 1 Adelaide       SA    Business     -0.868      1.25
 2 Adelaide       SA    Holiday       1.00       1.26
 3 Adelaide       SA    Other         4.90      -6.11
 4 Adelaide       SA    Visiting      0.306      1.48
 5 Adelaide Hills SA    Business     -5.00      -0.526
 6 Adelaide Hills SA    Holiday      -0.628     -1.42
 7 Adelaide Hills SA    Other        -0.256     -2.92
 8 Adelaide Hills SA    Visiting     -1.80      -2.18
 9 Alice Springs  NT    Business      1.07      -2.56
10 Alice Springs  NT    Holiday       4.36       7.31
# i 294 more rows
```

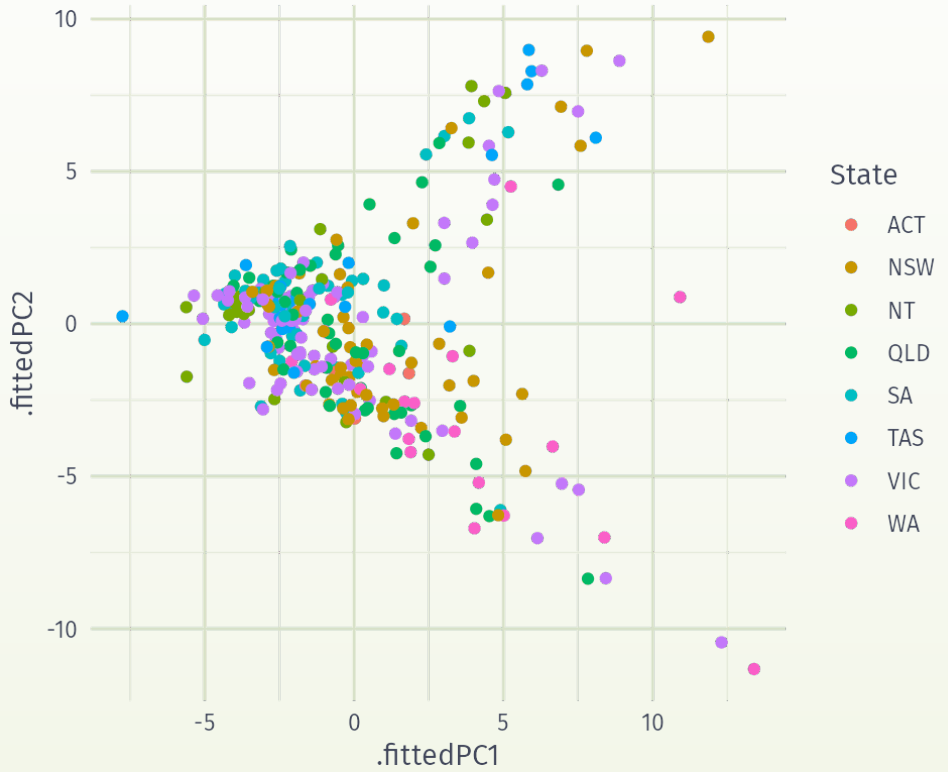
PC1 vs PC2

```
pcs |>
  ggplot(aes(x = .fittedPC1, y = .fittedPC2)) +
  geom_point() +
  theme(aspect.ratio = 1)
```



PCs coloured by State

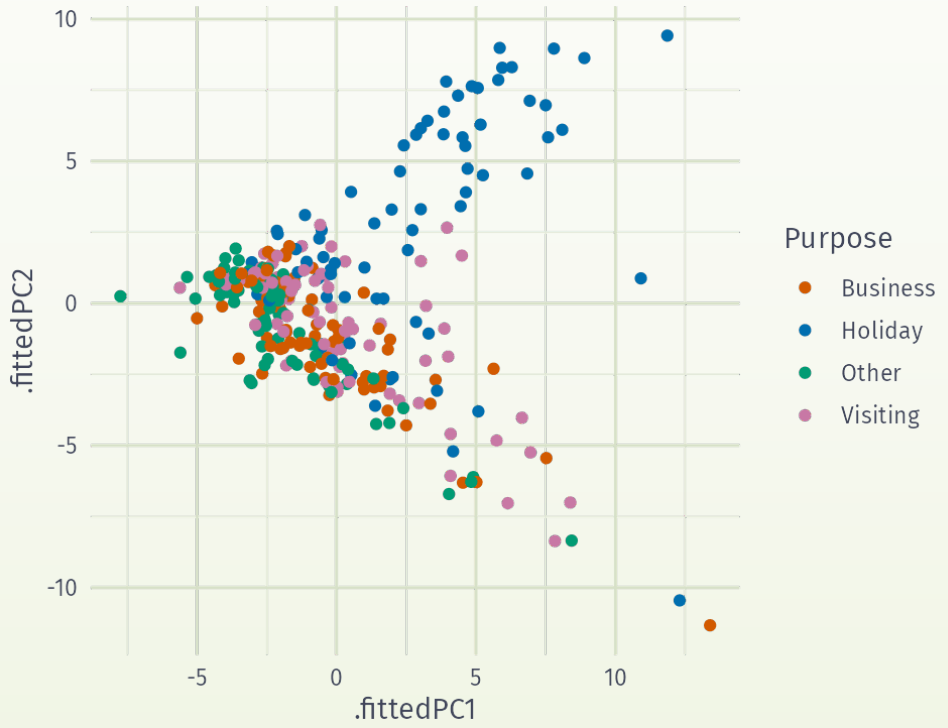
```
pcs |>
  ggplot(aes(x = .fittedPC1, y = .fittedPC2,
             col = State)) +
  geom_point() +
  theme(aspect.ratio = 1)
```



PCs coloured by Purpose

Holiday series sit higher on both PCs than other travel purposes.

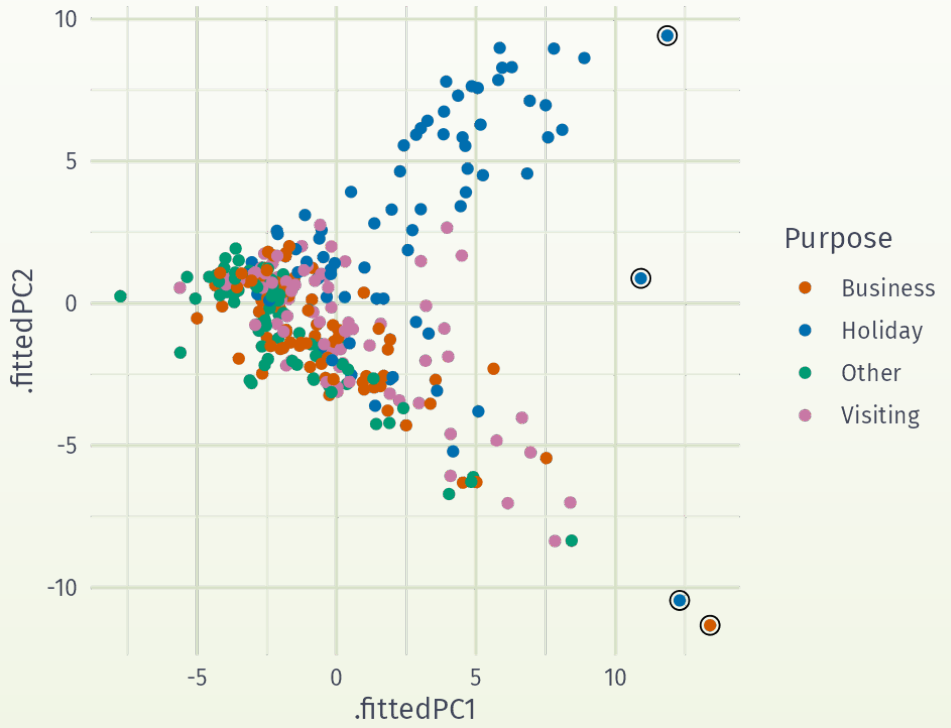
```
pcs |>
  ggplot(aes(x = .fittedPC1, y = .fittedPC2,
             col = Purpose)) +
  geom_point() +
  theme(aspect.ratio = 1)
```



Outliers in PC space

Four outlying series: PC1 > 12, or PC1 > 10 and PC2 > 0.

```
outliers <- pcs |>
  filter(.fittedPC1 > 12 |
           (.fittedPC1 > 10 & .fittedPC2 > 0))
pcs |>
  ggplot(aes(x = .fittedPC1, y = .fittedPC2,
             col = Purpose)) +
  geom_point() +
  geom_point(data = outliers, col = "black",
             shape = 1, size = 3) +
  theme(aspect.ratio = 1)
```



Outlying series

```
tourism |>
  semi_join(outliers, by = join_by(State, Region, Purpose)) |>
  mutate(Series = glue("{State}", "{Region}", "{Purpose}", .sep = "\n\n")) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = Quarter, y = Trips)) +
  geom_line() + facet_grid(Series ~ .) +
  labs(title = "Outlying time series in PC space")
```

